

Think Like a Forest

Foresight · Retreats · 3 days on land

A 3-day forest retreat that teaches leadership teams to sense in canopies, roots and mycelium instead of orgcharts.

The three journeys

Narrative. You walked into a forest expecting a metaphor and left with a decision system.

Cognitive. Forest ontology: canopy (vision), trunk (structure), roots (values), mycelium (relational intelligence).

Identity. From org-chart holder to canopy-reader.

Curriculum by module

Module 1 — Day 1 — Arrival

6h · Love — Why this matters

Outcome: Fire of questions lit.

Intent: Slow the body enough for slower thoughts to arrive.

Prompt question: What did you already know before you walked in?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
The Long Arrival	40m	Walk 40 minutes in silence to the site. No phones.	Circle-check: 'What did the walk do to your first sentence?'
Root Introduction	20m	One-line intro: 'What holds me is ____.' No job titles.	Notice what is not said.
The Fire Question	25m	Speak the one question you carried into the forest. Then place a stick on the fire.	No responses. The question stays.

Artifact: A fire of unanswered questions.

Module 2 — Day 1 evening — Reframe

3h · Magic — The reframe

Outcome: Canopy sketch begun.

Intent: Break the org-chart lens with a living-system lens.

Prompt question: What if your team is a canopy, not a hierarchy?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
Canopy Mapping	30m	Spend 30 min in one spot studying the canopy above. Sketch what you see.	Ask: 'What role does your team play in your org's canopy?'
Mycelium Walk	60m	Walk with a guide who points out the mycelial network of one hectare.	Ask: 'Where are the mycelial channels in your org?'
Deadwood Inventory	30m	Find deadwood in the forest. List what it feeds.	Ask: 'What in your org is decaying productively?'

Artifact: A canopy sketch, a mycelium map, a deadwood inventory.

Module 3 — Day 2 morning — Framework

4h · Calm — Organize complexity

Outcome: Forest blueprint drawn.

Intent: Turn the forest lens into an org-legible framework.

Prompt question: What is the shape of your organizational forest?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
The Forest Blueprint	60m	Draw: canopy (vision), trunks (functions), roots (values), mycelium (relational intelligence), deadwood (legacy).	Present to the group. Take questions.
Season Overlay	30m	Every current initiative gets a season: seed / growth / flower / harvest / decay.	Ask: 'Are we planting when we should be harvesting?'
Keystone Species	20m	Name 3 keystone people. Name 3 keystone practices.	Ask: 'How do we protect the keystones without freezing the forest?'

Artifact: A forest blueprint of the organization.

Module 4 — Day 2 afternoon — Sensing

5h · Open — Pattern discovery

Outcome: Sit spot + council held.

Intent: Sit still long enough for the forest to speak back.

Prompt question: What has the forest been telling you that you weren't hearing?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
Sit Spot	60m	Choose a spot. Sit for 60 min. Do not journal until the hour is up.	Only after: write one paragraph.
Council of Trees	45m	In circle, each person speaks as a tree, root, animal, or stream about the org.	Notice which voice keeps returning.
Weather Read	240m	Hourly: one word for the group's weather. Post to a shared board.	End of day: read the weather pattern.

Artifact: A day of weather reads. A council transcript.

Module 5 — Day 3 — Descent

5h · Free — Commitment

Outcome: Descent letter sealed. Seed taken.

Intent: Return with one decision the forest helped shape.

Prompt question: What decision are you carrying back down the mountain?

Exercise	Time	Prompt	Debrief
The Descent	30m	Handwritten letter to open at 9am	Trust the forest self more than the

Letter		Monday. Seal it.	Monday self.
Keystone Commitment	15m	Name the keystone and the protection. State it in circle.	Witness assigned by the group.
Seed Package	5m	Take one physical seed. Plant it within 7 days. Photo when it sprouts.	The sprout is your first status report.

Artifact: A sealed letter. A planted seed. A named keystone commitment.

Commitment contract

Which keystone will you protect between now and the next equinox?

Between now and _____ I will protect the keystone of _____ by _____. My witness in the circle is _____.

Witness — One person from the retreat circle.